

NAME

mbsslayout – translate time-based sidescan sonar data into backscatter laid out into a regular array of pixels on the seafloor by projecting onto a topographic model.

VERSION

Version 5.0

SYNOPSIS

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mbsslayout [
  --verbose
  --help
  --input=datalist
  --format=format
  --platform-file=FILE
  --platform-target-sensor=SENSORID
  --output-source=record_kind
  --line-nameroot=name
  --line-time-list=filename
  --line-route=filename
  --line-check-bearing
  --line-name1=name
  --line-name2=name
  --line-range-threshold=value
  --topo-grid-file=filename
  --altitude-altitude
  --altitude-bottompick
  --altitude-bottompick-threshold=threshold[/blank]
  --altitude-topo-grid
  --channel-swap
  --swath-width=value
  --interpolation=value
  --nav-file=filename
  --nav-file-format=format_id
  --nav-async=record_kind
  --sensordepth-file=filename
  --sensordepth-file-format=format_id
  --sensordepth-async=record_kind
  --altitude-file=filename
  --altitude_file-format=format_id
  --altitude-async=record_kind
  --heading-file=filename
  --heading-file-format=format_id
  --heading-async=record_kind
  --attitude-file=filename
  --attitude-file-format=format_id
  --attitude-async=record_kind
  --soundspeed-constant=value
  --soundspeed-file=filename
  --soundspeed-file-format=format_id
  --soundspeed-async=record_kind
  --timeshift-file=filename
  --timeshift-constant=value
  --timeshift-apply-nav
  --timeshift-apply-sensordepth

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--timeshift-apply-altitude
--timeshift-apply-heading
--timeshift-apply-attitude
--timeshift-apply-all-ancillary
--timeshift-apply-survey
--timeshift-apply-all
]

```

DESCRIPTION

MBsslayout translates time-based sidescan sonar data into backscatter laid out onto a topographic model of the seafloor. The input should be a datalist referencing data files in a format containing time based sidescan sonar data (typically both port and starboard time series). Often the logged file will not include any form of swath bathymetry data. The output will be sidescan data for which each ping return is represented by a single array of pixels with acrosstrack and alongtrack locations, where in the acrosstrack direction the pixels are uniformly sized (and therefore uniformly spaced). The output will be written to files in the MBF_MBLDEOIH format (MBIO format id 71).

The time series sidescan is "laid out" onto the seafloor using the two-travel time of each sample, it's orientation (port or starboard), the speed of sound, the location and orientation of the sonar, and some knowledge or assumption about the seafloor topography. The "laying out" process involves defining a regularly spaced array of acrosstrack pixels for which the pixel size (in meters) and the number of pixels determines the width of the array; this array is centered under the sonar location in an assumption that the swath center is approximately beneath the sonar. The location of each original sidescan sample on the seafloor, and the corresponding pixel in the destination sidescan array, is calculated according to the parameters listed above. The sidescan samples are binned in the destination array, with averaging applied for destination pixels holding more than one sample. After the averaging is calculated, empty pixels surrounded by valid data can be filled by interpolation.

The maximum number of pixels in the output swath sidescan is 4001. By default, **mbsslayout** varies the pixel size between pings in order to accommodate the full sidescan swath width within 4001 pixels. The calculation of the swath width W is:

$$W = 2.2 * \sqrt{R * R - A * A}$$

where A is the sonar altitude and R is the maximum range:

$$R = 0.5 * V * dt * N$$

Here dt is the sample interval in the time series sidescan, N is the maximum number of samples in a time series sidescan channel, and V is the speed of sound. Alternatively, the swath width can be specified to be a constant distance. Given the swath width W , whether it varies or is constant, **mbsslayout** uses an acrosstrack pixel size of:

$$dx = W / 4000$$

The sidescan can be laid out using a flat bottom assumption, but is generally laid out onto a gridded topographic model derived from bathymetric mapping with other sensors. The gridded bathymetry data may be collected simultaneously with the sidescan from the same platform, or it may derive from other surveys. If no topographic model is specified, then the location of each sample is calculated assuming a flat bottom according to an altitude value. By default this altitude derives from the navigation available in the time series sidescan files, but it can also derive from picking the first bottom arrival in the time series sidescan data. In this case the altitude used is the average of the bottom picks from the port and starboard time series sidescan channels.

Navigation, attitude, altitude, and water sound speed values will by default, if available, derive from values contained in the time-based sidescan files. If necessary or desired, the ancillary values can be merged from separate files. Time latency corrections can be made to the ancillary data time series if needed.

Once the sidescan data have been laid out onto the seafloor and output to format 71 swath files, they can be

further processed using **MB-System** tools such as **mbbackangle** followed by **mbprocess**.

MB-SYSTEM AUTHORSHIP

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OPTIONS

--verbose

By default **mbsslayout** outputs minimal information to the shell. This option causes the program to output the control parameters at the start and various status messages as it runs.

--help

The **--help** option causes **mbsslayout** to print out a summary of its purpose and a listing of its control options, and then exit immediately.

--input=datalist

This option defines the input files containing the time series sidescan data. The *datalist* value typically denotes a datalist file containing a list of input swath data files and/or other datalist files. Alternatively, a single swath data file can also be specified.

--format=format

This option sets the **MBIO** format identifier for the input file specified with the **--input** option. By default, **mbsslayout** infers the format id from the input filename via use of the **MB-System** suffix convention ("*.mbXXX") or of other recognized file suffixes.

--platform-file=FILE

This option specifies an **MB-System** platform file to be read and used to define the positional and angular offsets between sensors on the source survey platform. Often the embedded navigation and attitude (and other ancillary) data are already referenced to the relevant sidescan sonar; in this case no platform model is required during sidescan layout. However, if the available navigation and attitude data are referenced to another sensor or location on the survey platform, a platform model allows calculation of the actual location and orientation of the sidescan sonar during the layout process.

--platform-target-sensor=SENSORID

This option specifies which sensor in the platform model specified with the **--platform-file** option is the source of the time series sidescan data being processed by **mbsslayout**.

--output-source=record_kind

This option specifies the **MB-System** data record type in the input source data that contains the time series sidescan data being processed by **mbsslayout**. The source data record type will not always be considered survey data (MB_DATA_DATA, ID=1) and may instead be secondary sidescan (MB_DATA_SIDESCAN2, ID=38) or tertiary sidescan (MB_DATA_SIDESCAN2, ID=39). For instance, Edgetech sidescan data are recorded in the Jstar format in files with a *.jsf suffix, and these files typically contain two frequencies of sidescan data. The records containing the lower frequency time series sidescan data will be reported as MB_DATA_DATA, and those containing the higher frequency time series sidescan data will be reported as MB_DATA_SIDESCAN2. The **MB-System** program **mbinfo** will, with the **-N** option, output a complete list of the data record types in a swath file, revealing the number of MB_DATA_DATA, MB_DATA_SIDESCAN2, and MB_DATA_SIDESCAN3 records present.

--line-time-list=filename

Specifies an ASCII text file containing a list of times used to define the start and ends of survey lines, allowing **mbsslayout** to structure the output files according to those survey lines. The output filenames will be constructed using the sequential line numbers (starting from 000) The times are defined in decimal epoch seconds (seconds since 1970) with one time value on each line. Such a time list file can be constructed from an **MB-System** route file using the program **mbrouatetime**.

--line-route=filename

Specifies an **MB-System** route file (typically generated using **mbgrdviz**) that defines the waypoints of a planned survey. The waypoints of this route are used in conjunction with the survey navigation to define the start and ends of survey lines, allowing **mbsslayout** to structure the output files according to those survey lines. Since the navigation of real surveys rarely passes through the planned waypoints exactly, the times at which waypoints are reached is calculated using a range threshold specified using the **--line-range-threshold** option.

--line-range-threshold=value

Specifies the range threshold used to define when survey navigation reaches a survey line waypoint. The range (distance) of the survey navigation to the waypoint should decrease as the waypoint is approached. The waypoint is considered to be reached when the range stops decreasing and starts to increase, provided the range is less than the range threshold when that occurs. The default value is 50 meters.

--line-name1=name

If **mbsslayout** is requested to output sidescan in files corresponding to survey lines, as defined either by a route file (option **--line-route**) or a list of time stamps (option **--line-time-list**), then the output files will have names of the form "N1"_ "N2"_XXXX.mb71, where "N1" is specified with **--output-name1**, "N2" is specified with **--output-name2**, and XXXX are the sequential line numbers (starting with "0000").

--line-name2=name

By default, **mbsslayout** outputs "laid-out" sidescan in format 71 files corresponding to the input files containing the time series sidescan data, where the output filenames consist of the original filename stripped of it's identifying suffix (e.g. ".jsf") and appended with "_N2".mb71. Here "N2" is specified with **--output-name2**. If **mbsslayout** is requested to output sidescan in files corresponding to survey lines, as defined either by a route file (option **--line-route**) or a list of time stamps (option **--line-time-list**), then the output files will have names of the form "N1"_ "N2"_XXXX.mb71, where "N1" is specified with **--output-name1**, "N2" is specified with **--output-name2**, and XXXX are the sequential line numbers (starting with "0000").

--topo-grid-file=filename

This option specifies a topographic model in the form of a GMT topography grid file to be used for laying out the sidescan. Each time series sidescan sample is projected into the topographic model using the sonar navigation and attitude so that the location of the sample on the seafloor is correct with respect to the full three dimensional survey geometry. If a topography model is not specified with this option, then the sidescan will be laid out using a flat bottom assumption and an altitude value derived either from the survey navigation or by picking the initial bottom return in the time series sidescan data.

--altitude-bottompick

Specifies obtaining the altitude value by picking the initial bottom return in the time series sidescan data. If no topographic model is specified with the **--topo-grid-file** option, then the sidescan will be laid out using using a flat bottom assumption and the altitude. The default altitude bottom-pick threshold is 0.5, meaning the bottom return is picked for each channel (port and starboard) at the first time the time series sidescan value reaches 0.5 times the maximum value. The altitude value used for the overall layout is the average of the values found for the port and starboard channels.

--altitude-bottompick-threshold=threshold[/blank]

Specifies the threshold used to pick the initial bottom return in the time series sidescan data. The default threshold is 0.5. If given, the value *blank* is the blanking interval in seconds that will be ignored in looking for the first bottom return. This option turns the bottompick altitude mode on, so it is unnecessary to also specify the **--altitude-bottompick** option.

--channel-swap

This option causes **mbsslayout** to swap the port and starboard time series sidescan channels before laying out the sidescan data on the seafloor.

--swath-width=value

Specifies a constant output swath width in meters. By default, **mbsslayout** varies the swath width according to the maximum range and altitude of the sidescan data. See the description section for details of the default swath width calculation and the sidescan layout process.

--interpolation=value

Specifies the degree to which gaps in the output swath sidescan are filled by interpolation. The interpolation value corresponds to the maximum number of adjacent empty pixels that is filled by interpolation; larger gaps are not filled by interpolation and remain empty in the output swath sidescan. The default is to do no interpolation.

--nav-file=filename

Specifies an external file from which to merge sonar position (navigation), replacing any navigation data included in the input time series sidescan files. By default **mbsslayout** attempts to use navigation values included in the input data.

--nav-file-format=format_id

Specifies the format of an external navigation file from which position values are derived (as defined with **--nav-file**). Options for the *format_id* value are:

- 1: ASCII text file with lines of the form:
time_d longitude latitude speed
where time_d is time in decimal epoch seconds (seconds since 1970), longitude and latitude are in decimal degrees, and speed is in km/hour (and is optional). South latitudes are negative. Longitude may be defined on either the -180.0 to +180.0 or 0.0 to 360.0 domains.
- 2: ASCII text file with lines of the form:
year month day hour minute second longitude latitude
where year, month, day, hour, and minute values are integers, the second value is decimal, and longitude and latitude are in decimal degrees. South latitudes are negative. Longitude may be defined on either the -180.0 to +180.0 or 0.0 to 360.0 domains.
- 3: ASCII text file with lines of the form:
year julian_day hour minute second longitude latitude
where year, julian_day, hour, and minute values are integers, the second value is decimal, and longitude and latitude are in decimal degrees. South latitudes are negative. Longitude may be defined on either the -180.0 to +180.0 or 0.0 to 360.0 domains.
- 4: ASCII text file with lines of the form:
year julian_day day_minute second longitude latitude
where year, julian_day, and day_minute values are integers, the second value is decimal, and longitude and latitude are in decimal degrees. South latitudes are negative. Longitude may be defined on either the -180.0 to +180.0 or 0.0 to 360.0 domains.
- 5: ASCII text file in the 1990's era L-DEO processed nav format with lines of the form:
yy+jjjhhmmssNddmmmmmmEddmmmmmm
where yy is the two digit year (after 1999 the "yy+" was replaced by a four

digit year "yyyy"), jjj is the julian_day, hh is the hour, mm is minutes, and ss is seconds. The latitude is given as Nddmmmmmmmand where N is 'N' for north and 'S' for south, dd are integer degrees, and mmmmmmm is minutes * 10000. The longitude is given as Edddmmmmmmand where E is 'E' for east and 'W' for west, ddd are integer degrees, and mmmmmmm is minutes * 10000.

6 or 7: NMEA 0183 position strings

Several NMEA and NMEA-like strings containing position are recognized, and can be parsed with and without line break characters. These strings include ZDA, GLL, GGA, DAT, and UNX.

8: Simrad 90 format navigation files with lines of the form:

ddmmyy hhmmssss ddmmmmmmmmN dddmmmmmmmmE
 where dd is day of the month, mm is the month, yy is the two digit year, hh is the hour, mm is the minute, and ssss is seconds * 100. The latitude is given as ddmmmmmmmmN where dd are integer degrees, mmmmmmmmm is minutes * 100000, and N is 'N' for north and 'S' for south latitude. The longitude is given as dddmmmmmmmmE where ddd are integer degrees, mmmmmmmmm is minutes * 100000, and E is 'E' for east and 'W' for west longitude.

day_minute values are integers, the second value is decimal, and longitude and latitude are in decimal degrees. The longitude is given as Edddmmmmmmand where E is 'E' for east and 'W' for west, ddd are integer degrees, and mmmmmmm is minutes * 10000.

9: ASCCI text file with white-space delimited lines of the form:

yr mon day hour min sec time_d lon lat heading speed sensordepth*
 where yr is the four digit year, mon is the month, day is the day of the month, min is the minute, second is the decimal seconds, time_d is time in decimal epoch seconds (seconds since 1970), lon is the longitude in decimal degrees, lat is the latitude in decimal degrees, heading is in decimal degrees, speed is in km/hour, and sensordepth is in meters. South latitudes are negative. Longitude may be defined on either the -180.0 to +180.0 or 0.0 to 360.0 domains.

10: R2R (Rolling deck to Repository) navigation format with ASCCI text lines of the form:

yyyy-mm-ddThh:mm:ss.sssZ lon lat quality nsat dilution height
 where the lon and lat fields are in decimal degrees with south latitudes and west longitudes negative, and the last four quantities relating to GPS fix quality.

--nav-async=record_kind

Specifies the type of data records from which position values are derived (as defined with **--nav-file-format**). Options for the *record_kind* include:

- MB_DATA_DATA: 1 (survey data)
- MB_DATA_NAV: 12 (navigation data)
- MB_DATA_NAV1: 29 (navigation data from navigation system 1)
- MB_DATA_NAV2: 30 (navigation data from navigation system 2)
- MB_DATA_NAV3: 31 (navigation data from navigation system 3)

What types of data records are present is format-dependent, as is the default choice of which record type is used as the navigation source by default. The program **mbinfo** can be used with the **-N** option to determine the numbers of different record types present in a data file.

--sensordepth-file=filename

Specifies an external file from which to merge sensor depth, replacing any sensor depth data included in the input time series sidescan files. By default **mbsslayout** attempts to use sensor depth values included in the input data.

--sensordepth-file-format=format_id

Specifies the format of an external sensor depth file from which sensor depth values are derived (as defined with **--sensordepth-file**). Options for the *format_id* value are:

1: ASCII text file with lines of the form:

time_d longitude latitude speed

where time_d is time in decimal epoch seconds (seconds since 1970), longitude and latitude are in decimal degrees, and speed is in km/hour (and is optional).

South latitudes are negative. Longitude may be defined on either the -180.0 to +180.0 or 0.0 to 360.0 domains.

2: ASCII text file with lines of the form:

year month day hour minute second longitude latitude

where year, month, day, hour, and minute values are integers, the second value is decimal, and longitude and latitude are in decimal degrees.

South latitudes are negative. Longitude may be defined on either the -180.0 to +180.0 or 0.0 to 360.0 domains.

--sensordepth-async=record_kind**--altitude-file=filename**

Specifies an external file from which to merge altitude, replacing any altitude data included in the input time series sidescan files. By default **mbsslayout** attempts to use altitude values included in the input data.

--altitude_file-format=format_id**--altitude-async=record_kind****--heading-file=filename**

Specifies an external file from which to merge heading, replacing any heading data included in the input time series sidescan files. By default **mbsslayout** attempts to use heading values included in the input data.

--heading-file-format=format_id**--heading-async=record_kind****--attitude-file=filename**

Specifies an external file from which to merge attitude (roll and pitch), replacing any attitude data included in the input time series sidescan files. By default **mbsslayout** attempts to use attitude values included in the input data.

--attitude-file-format=format_id**--attitude-async=record_kind****--soundspeed-constant=value****--soundspeed-file=filename**

Specifies an external file from which to merge water sound speed, replacing any sound speed data included in the input time series sidescan files. By default **mbsslayout** attempts to use sound speed values included in the input data.

--soundspeed-file-format=format_id**--soundspeed-async=record_kind****--timeshift-file=filename**

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--timeshift-constant=value  
--timeshift-apply-nav  
--timeshift-apply-sensordepth  
--timeshift-apply-altitude  
--timeshift-apply-heading  
--timeshift-apply-attitude  
--timeshift-apply-all-ancilliary  
--timeshift-apply-survey  
--timeshift-apply-all
```

EXAMPLES

To be written.....

SEE ALSO

mbsystem(1), **mbdatalist(1)**, **mbprocess(1)**

BUGS

Oh yeah.